

Prizes at HackRice

MLH Challenges & Sponsor Prizes

Win prizes, hacker gear, and swag by entering one of these challenges and building with new APIs. There are 8 challenges below — a project can be submitted to more than one.

1. Best Use of Gemini API

Prize: Google Swag Kits

The challenge is to stretch what AI can do using Google Gemini. The Gemini API lets you build AI-powered apps that will impress the people around you. Some of what Gemini can bring to a hackathon project:

- Human-like language understanding — for example, a chatbot that gives personalized advice.
- Supercomputer-grade analysis — for example, an app that condenses dense research papers.
- Creative generation — code, scripts, music, and more.

Consider the range of what's possible, and decide what you'll build with the Google Gemini API this weekend.

Build with Gemini → <https://mlh.link/gemini>

2. Best Use of ElevenLabs

Prize: Wireless Earbuds

ElevenLabs lets you ship natural, human-sounding audio. You can produce realistic, dynamic, emotionally expressive voices for anything — interactive AI companions, narrated stories, voice-enabled apps. It makes rich, immersive audio experiences possible without hiring voice actors or running a complicated production pipeline; the AI handles it.

Add fully autonomous audio to your hack, give the project a voice, and put your team in the running for a set of wireless earbuds.

Build with ElevenLabs → <https://mlh.link/elevenlabs>

3. Best Use of Solana

Prize: Ledger Nano S Plus

Development is changing quickly, and Solana is out front with a network built for serious infrastructure demands. High fees and slow confirmations are off the table — this is about applications that are fast, efficient, and scalable.

Lean on Solana's strengths, namely very fast execution and transaction costs close to zero, to turn hackathon ideas into something that works in the real world. A few directions:

- A game, social app, or consumer product built around instant, high-frequency transactions.
- A sophisticated trading, lending, or decentralized exchange (DEX) product.
- A prototype for supply chain, identity, or payments that can absorb real-world volume.

Show how you innovate with Solana and your whole team has a shot at the prize.

Build with Solana → <https://mlh.link/solana>

4. Best Use of Tiger Data

Prize: Stream Deck Mini

Shipping a high-performance app on a hackathon clock shouldn't cost you half the weekend in database setup or obscure query syntax. Tiger Data builds on PostgreSQL to give student developers a very fast base for real-time data, time-series metrics, and heavy analytics.

Reasons to build on it this weekend:

- Standard SQL power — query huge datasets right away with SQL you already know; no NoSQL aggregation pipelines.
- Unified data stack — relational user profiles and high-frequency metric streams live side by side in one database.
- Instant dashboards — pre-computed Continuous Aggregates feed real-time frontend charts without lag.
- Over 90% data compression — keep millions of events on free-tier cloud instances without exhausting disk.

Real-time IoT monitoring, AI-driven analytics dashboards, financial prediction engines — whatever you're building, show how Tiger Data powers it. The team with the most innovative, impactful, performance-minded use of it wins.

Build with Tiger Data → <https://mlh.link/tigerdata>

5. Best Use of Presage

Prize: Fitbit Inspire & Presage Perks

Presage is building what it calls the Human Sensing Layer: a way for any application to read a person's physical and emotional state in real time. Clinically-proven vital signs, movement, emotion, and focus tracking let you turn an ordinary camera into something far more capable.

Any of the Presage SDKs will fold real-time heart rate, breathing rate, engagement levels, and facial expressions into your hack in only a few lines of code. Ideas:

- Immersive gaming and entertainment — shift game difficulty or story beats based on how excited or focused the player is.
- Contactless wellness and fitness — a non-invasive app tracking stress, recovery, or performance.
- Accessibility and security — vital signs for frictionless authentication or improved accessibility.
- Productivity — a tool that measures focus or stress.

Build with Presage and show where human-computer interaction is headed. Winners take prizes plus these perks from the Presage team:

- Free refills of Presage development credits for your next three months of building.
- 30% off all Presage usage charges for your first year after going live.

Presage SDKs → <https://mlh.link/presage-sdk>

Build with Presage → <https://mlh.link/presage>

6. Best Use of Vultr

Prize: Portable Screens

Vultr gets high-performance projects running immediately — one-click deployment, scalable cloud compute, and Vultr Cloud GPUs for AI-driven applications. The point is to see what you build once infrastructure stops being the bottleneck.

Create a Vultr account and claim your free cloud credits. Move your hack to the cloud with Vultr and your team could win portable screens.

Build with Vultr → <https://mlh.link/vultr>

7. Best Use of Backboard

Prize: Tile Essentials Pack

Every AI model API is stateless out of the box, so your app forgets everything the moment a session closes. State management deserves to be step one of any AI build regardless of the LLM behind it, and Backboard hands it to you for free.

It goes further than state management, though. Backboard is one unified API, built on the top-ranked AI memory, covering long-term memory, RAG, embeddings, tool calls, model routing across more than 17,000 LLMs, and context that survives every page refresh, session, and user. No stitching five services together — one API, one integration.

A short sample of what it makes possible:

- AI-powered travel guide that recalls allergies and preferences from earlier trips.
- Personalized fitness coach that adapts workouts to progress and injury history.
- Smart home controller that learns routines and anticipates lighting and climate preferences.

Use Backboard for a persistent, seamless user experience without the usual infrastructure headache. Every member of the winning team gets a Tile Essentials Pack — like AI, we all need help remembering where things are. Note: sign in on the MLH event page to claim your Backboard code.

Build with Backboard → <https://mlh.link/backboard>

Log in to claim code → https://www.mlh.com/signin?return_to=%2Fevents%2Fhackrice-71%2Fprizes

8. Best Domain Name from GoDaddy Registry

Prize: Digital Gift Card

GoDaddy Registry is supplying what you need to hack well from anywhere. Register your domain name with GoDaddy Registry for a shot at the prize.

Build with GoDaddy Registry → <https://mlh.link/GoDaddyRegistry>

Source: mlh.com/events/hackrice-71/prizes | Prize descriptions summarized from the MLH event page. Check the live page for updates, official rules, and eligibility. Major League Hacking © 2026.